

Monitoring children?

If you want to check what your kids are upto or block out certain objectionable sites, try the Crawler Parental Control application at <http://cnet.co/dVWSXF>

Super Duper Computer!

US Department of Energy (DOE) has hired IBM to build the fastest computer capable of 10 quadrillion calculations per second

MONITOR YOUR EMPLOYEES

Here's how SoHos and SMEs can monitor employees using easy to use monitoring, reporting and tracking software. It's time to snuff out resource wastage and get your organisation's productivity up.

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It's a well known fact that employees are known to play hookie from work. Whether it's common distractions like spending endless hours socialising on Facebook, YouTube surfing, or tending to virtual farms on Farmville, there's a lot of productive time being wasted the world over. The problem doesn't just extend to illegitimate internet usage. Employees are known to play truant in a number of ways. Your office printer might be churning out nice full-colour prints of an employee's child's school project. A coterie of work-buddies may be having extended lunch breaks, and water-cooler conversations that may be lengthier than an entire Koffee with Karan episode. According to a survey by www.salary.com, 22 per cent employees waste approximately 2 hrs daily at work. 44.7 per cent of those polled cited web surfing as their number one distraction at work. Socialising with co-workers came in second at 23.4 per cent.

Conducting personal business, spacing out, running errands, and making personal phone calls were the other popular time-wasting activities in the workplace.

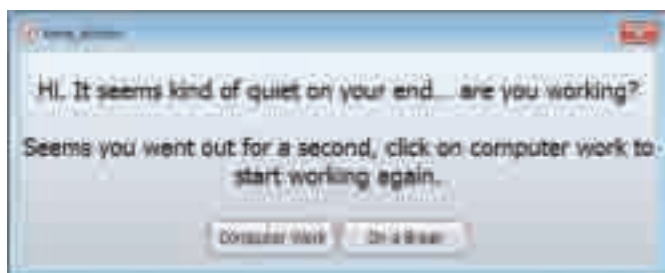
Now, as an employer you might be willing to turn a blind eye to genuine personal work such as personal mail or banking transactions, which is why you may not have implemented a draconian IT policy that blocks everything across the board. But even genuine occasions of personal usage of office resources need to be regulated and only be allowed a certain quantum of time. In this article we highlight a few applications that will keep your employees under check and improve your organisation's overall productivity. These are apps that will silently record and in some cases restrict usage of company resources. On a side note some of them can also be used by parents to keep an eye on miscreant kids and teenagers. Read on.

How do your minions spend their day?

There are several applications out there that will help you keep track of what your employees are up to. Some are paid solutions such as Work Examiner (www.workexaminer.com) that offer

a host of functionalities from internet and application monitoring to filtering and report generation thrown in. At the same time there are free solutions such as Time Doctor (www.timedoctor.com), and SurveilStar Activity Monitor (www.any-activity-monitor.com) that help keep track of your employees daily activity that includes remotely accessible timed screen shots. SurveilStar Activity Monitor captures the Network Adapter on client machines and reports to a server. The software can block web sites and optionally simply report the list of web sites visited and also time spent at each site. We had trouble setting it up on a complicated network.

Instead TimeDoctor was very easy to install and get working, thanks to its strong web integration. It's easy to deploy for a significantly large number of personnel too. All you have to do is register an account and add any number of employees to your workgroup by providing their email addresses. As an admin, you can assign statuses to employees such as Manager or User. Step-by-step instructions for installing the client software are emailed automatically to each of your employees. More than just surveillance, the software



Dude where's my productivity



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